



## Space in VR!

A kickstarter campaign has been started by SpaceVR to send a 12-camera rig that shoots 3D, 360-degree video in VR. <http://dgit.in/3dspacevr>



## 4K from space

Nasa has released a space grown food event in 4K. Check it out here: <http://dgit.in/nasasalad4k>

**Smartphones**

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**S**o, Samsung just launched the next iteration of its Note series. You know what that means? Of course you do! It means a new generation of Android flagships is coming. That consequently means this generation of flagships are going to get cheaper. So, it's the perfect time to draw out a comparison between the best out there. Make a note of these devices, as

any of them may pick up a Zero1 Award or two in a few months.

The market is flooded with phones today, and unlike the old days, there's much more quality available. Deciding which smartphone to buy is somewhat like Sophie's choice nowadays isn't it? Do you want a good camera? Do you want power? Or maybe battery life is what you're going for.

Well, a flagship, by definition should be a complete smartphone. This means it is premium to the power of infinity

and shows the best the company can do in all aspects. We have a pretty formidable collection of phones too, some from this last generation, and some a bit older, since their successors haven't come to India yet.

In case you're wondering, yes, the OnePlus 2 is part of the comparison. Although, we must say that unlike most comparisons where we wait for the results to speak for themselves, this time we were quite sure of the outcome already. Given the internal firing power of the

devices here, there were hardly any surprises as far as the test results go.

So, without further ado, let's get down to brass tacks.

## SONY XPERIA Z3+

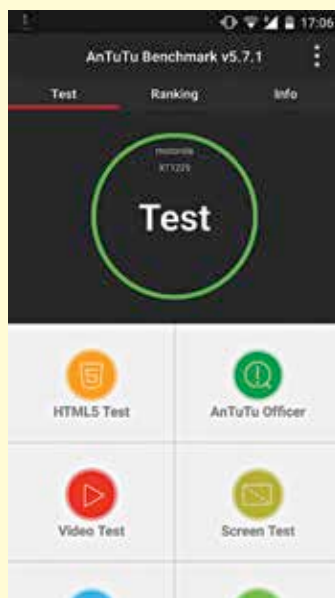
Sony's current flagship has been caught in the Qualcomm Snapdragon 810 debacle. Unfortunately for the company, it couldn't deal with the heating issues on this processor effectively. Hence, if you're using this phone, you will have a phone that literally heats up at the drop of a dime.

## HOW WE TESTED

Testing flagships is always more difficult than others. In a camera comparison, we look at just the camera, while battery life comparisons put the main emphasis on battery. In flagships though, you have to test everything, and ensure that you pick the absolute best performer.

We started of course by using synthetic benchmarks, gaining an idea of what each phone can do in a simulated environment. A huge part of our focus though was on real world testing, what does the phone's SoC lack? Mobile processors today boast huge number of cores with higher clock speeds, but we all know heating is an issue, especially in India. So, we made sure to pick a winner that doesn't have heating issues.

Next came the comprehensive camera tests. This was probably the toughest part of the job. Have you seen the cameras manufacturers are putting on their flagships today? Well, they can never be too good though right? So, we put them through the usual tests. We took the nine phones in this test and clicked identical images under low light, sunlight, indoor fluorescent lights and the yellow lights we have in our studio. We took these images and put them side by side to



this there's the daily regular usage parameter, which all phones that are tested here have gone through, and hence we have an idea of how long the battery lasts under practical situations.

With performance, battery and camera out of the way, we were left with the build quality and design of each of the phones. In addition, their respective UIs/OSs were also taken into consideration since they've come to play a big part in the user experience with each passing day. So with all that done, we were now sure of which phone would be the absolute best performer and which would be the best buy. There's also the editor's pick,

which is the phone we would buy, irrespective of the results of the comparison.

figure out which one's are the best, which fell just short and so on.

Next came the battery life tests. This was a mixture of our own looping video test and the Geekbench 3 battery test. We've come to trust this benchmark a lot, since it allows for exactly the same conditions on each device. The Geekbench 3 battery test takes the battery from 100% to 1% and notes the time taken to do so. Having done this on each device and matched it with the scores on our own looping video tests, we have a clear idea of which phone's battery lasts the longest. On top of all

Lastly, the phones that are part of this comparison are – Samsung Galaxy S6 Edge, LG G4, Sony Xperia Z3+, OnePlus 2, HTC One M9+, Asus Zenfone 2, Huawei Honor 6 Plus, Motorola Moto Turbo and last but not the least, the Xiaomi Mi 4. As mentioned before, the Moto Turbo, Xiaomi Mi 4 and Honor 6 Plus don't have their successors in India yet, so they were taken as the current flagships from their respective brands.

Now that we're through explaining that, here's how things turned out.